

Five Lakes Manufacturing — Managed Data & Reporting Services

Sayer Proposal — February 2026

More than a report writer. A complete data foundation — architecture, engineering, dashboards, and ongoing support — at a fraction of the cost of a single hire.

Our Understanding of Your Situation

Five Lakes is in the middle of a significant operational transformation. CRM is being implemented, ERP selection is underway, and CPQ integration is on the roadmap. Each of these creates real demand for someone who can pull data, build reports, and support decision-making — right now.

The immediate need is clear:

- ODBC access to Passport is now live, but there is limited internal capability to extract and use the data
- Leadership needs operational dashboards, cost models, and reporting that does not live in spreadsheets
- The business is interviewing for a full-time data analyst at ~\$95K, but recruiting for this skill set takes time — and the need exists today
- The role has a wide mandate: data pulls, cost modeling, pricing analysis, forecasting, ERP data prep, and KPI dashboards

The harder reality:

- A single hire writes reports. They do not build the infrastructure underneath — the database, the pipelines, the automated refresh, the visualization layer. You would still need to buy and manage those separately.
- Once the ERP is implemented, the nature of this work changes significantly — full-time demand may not persist at the same level
- Recruiting, onboarding, and managing a technical resource internally adds overhead in a team that is already stretched
- If that person leaves, the reports leave with them. There is no system, no documentation, and no continuity.

What We Are Proposing

A managed data services engagement that gives Five Lakes a dedicated, experienced data resource — plus the architecture, engineering, and tooling that a single hire cannot deliver alone.

📌 This is not staff augmentation. You are not renting a person. You are getting a team and a system.

The team:

- A dedicated SQL and reporting analyst with multiple years of experience, working full-time in Phase 1
- Weston Baker as your day-to-day project lead — already embedded in your CRM and CPQ work, managing requirements and keeping deliverables aligned
- Billy Leigh providing strategic oversight at no additional cost — ensuring data work connects to the broader CRM, ERP, and CPQ transformation
- Access to Sayer's data architecture and engineering bench for infrastructure design, pipeline development, and platform decisions

What gets delivered:

- A working data warehouse — not a folder of spreadsheets
- Automated data pipelines that refresh without manual intervention
- Dashboards and visualizations accessible to leadership, finance, sales, and operations
- Documented data schema that directly feeds your ERP migration
- Cost models, profitability analysis, and operational KPIs built on a foundation that persists after the engagement scales down

What the JD asks for — and how we cover it:

- SQL-based data extraction from Passport and other operational systems
- KPI dashboard development and ongoing maintenance
- Product cost and profitability models (materials, labor, overhead, logistics)
- Pricing analysis and scenario modeling
- Data mapping, cleansing, and schema documentation for ERP migration
- Cross-functional reporting for leadership, finance, sales, procurement, and operations

A Hire vs. A System: What You Actually Get

With a \$95K Data Analyst Hire

- One person writing reports from day one (after recruiting and onboarding)
- Reports live in Excel or local files — no shared infrastructure
- No data warehouse, no automated pipelines, no visualization platform
- If they leave, the reports and institutional knowledge leave with them
- You still need to procure, configure, and manage BI tooling separately
- Limited to one person's skill set — typically strong in either engineering or analysis, rarely both

With Sayer's Managed Data Service

- A dedicated analyst supported by a project manager, strategic advisor, and engineering bench
- A centralized data warehouse with automated extraction and refresh — a system, not a person
- Dashboards and visualizations built on scalable infrastructure that your team can access directly
- Full schema documentation that survives personnel changes and directly accelerates ERP implementation
- Cross-system integration capability — Passport, CRM, future ERP, CAD data — not siloed reporting
- Month-to-month flexibility to scale up for projects or scale down as the ERP absorbs reporting needs
- No recruiting delay, no onboarding ramp, no employment overhead, no backfill risk

Bottom line: A hire gives you a person. This engagement gives you a person, a platform, and a plan — with the flexibility to evolve as your systems do.

What Gets Built in Phase 1

During the first 12 weeks, the resource operates full-time with a focus on establishing a working data foundation and delivering immediate reporting value.

Data Architecture & Engineering

- Lightweight cloud data warehouse established (AWS, Azure, or Google Cloud — based on your environment)
- ODBC connectivity to Passport fully operationalized with automated extraction
- Structured data pipelines with scheduled refresh — no manual pulls, no version drift
- Data quality validation and transformation layer ensuring reporting accuracy
- Architecture designed to integrate future data sources (ERP, CAD, HRIS) without rebuilding

Reporting, Dashboards & Visualization

- Operational KPI dashboards accessible via Power BI, Looker Studio, or your preferred tool
- Product cost models with drill-down by material, labor, overhead, and logistics
- Sales and margin reporting with trend analysis and benchmarking
- Profitability analysis and scenario modeling to support pricing decisions
- Ad hoc reports and data pulls as leadership priorities emerge

ERP Migration Readiness

- Passport data schema fully mapped and documented — this becomes your ERP migration blueprint
- Data quality assessment identifying gaps, inconsistencies, and remediation needs
- Migration-ready data structures that carry forward when the new ERP goes live
- Historical data preservation strategy ensuring continuity through the transition

Delivery approach: Weekly check-ins, transparent task tracking, and continuous alignment with leadership priorities. No scope surprises.

Cost Comparison

Full-Time Hire — True Cost (Year 1)

Component	Annual Cost
Base Salary	\$95,000
Benefits & Taxes (25%)	\$23,750
Recruiting Fees (est. 15%)	\$14,250
Onboarding, Training, Ramp Time	\$5,000+
BI Tooling & Infrastructure (separate)	Not included
Management Overhead	Not quantified
Total Year 1	\$138,000+

Plus 8–12 weeks of recruiting timeline before work begins. No data warehouse, no automated pipelines, no visualization platform included. Backfill risk if the hire does not work out.

Sayer Managed Data Service

Phase	Monthly Cost	Duration
Phase 1 — Full Engagement	~\$11,500/month	Months 1–3
Phase 2 — Scaled Support	~\$5,775/month	Month 4+

First 12 months with Sayer: ~\$86,475

Savings vs. full-time hire: ~\$51,500 (37%)

Includes the analyst, project management, strategic oversight, data architecture, engineering, and visualization platform — not just a person writing reports.

Work starts immediately. No recruiting delay. No employment overhead. Month-to-month flexibility in Phase 2.

Phase Structure

1

Phase 1: Build the Foundation (Months 1–3)

Full-time engagement focused on standing up the data infrastructure and delivering immediate reporting value.

- Data warehouse, pipelines, and automated refresh established
- Initial dashboards and cost models delivered
- Passport schema documented for ERP migration
- Reporting foundation built to scale with the business

~\$11,500/month — all-inclusive

Includes dedicated analyst, project management, strategic oversight, data architecture, and infrastructure setup.

2

Phase 2: Operate & Evolve (Month 4+)

Scaled to part-time as the foundation is in place and the work shifts to maintenance and iteration.

- Dashboard maintenance, updates, and new report development
- Continued ERP data migration support
- Ad hoc analysis and reporting as business needs evolve
- Infrastructure monitoring and optimization

~\$5,775/month — all-inclusive

Month-to-month flexibility. Scale hours up for specific projects. Scale down as the ERP absorbs reporting needs. Pause entirely if the work is done. No long-term commitment required.

Why This Is More Valuable Than It Looks

Synergies with existing Sayer work

Five Lakes is already working with Sayer on CRM (HubSpot), ERP selection, and CPQ integration. A managed data resource from the same team creates compounding advantages that a standalone hire or separate vendor cannot replicate.

- Schema documentation from Phase 1 becomes the ERP migration blueprint — eliminating redundant discovery and accelerating implementation
- The data warehouse survives the ERP transition — preserving historical data and reporting continuity rather than rebuilding from scratch
- As CRM, ERP, and CPQ come online, the reporting layer connects all three — giving leadership a unified view, not siloed dashboards
- One team with full context on your business, systems, and growth targets — no ramp time, no knowledge gaps

Future capabilities enabled

The infrastructure built in this engagement is not a dead end. It creates a foundation for:

- Automated supply chain and demand forecasting
- Cross-system analytics connecting sales, operations, and finance
- AI-ready data structures when the business is ready to explore advanced analytics
- Self-service reporting for department heads without requiring technical support

Risk reduction

- No single-point-of-failure — the system works even if people change
- Documented processes and architecture — institutional knowledge lives in the system, not in someone's head
- Proven resource with immediate productivity — no 90-day ramp wondering if the hire will work out

Working Terms & Next Steps

Next Steps

- 1 Confirm engagement and target start date
- 2 Schedule kickoff with John, Jim, and the Sayer team
- 3 Begin ODBC connectivity validation and requirements gathering in Week 1

Engagement Model

- Monthly engagement fee, invoiced on the 15th and last day of each month
- All resource costs, project management, strategic oversight, and infrastructure setup included
- Month-to-month in Phase 2 — either party may adjust scope or discontinue with 30 days written notice

What Five Lakes Provides

- ODBC access credentials and Passport system documentation
- Access to key stakeholders for requirements gathering and validation
- Timely feedback on deliverables and priorities
- Cloud infrastructure account (Sayer facilitates setup and configuration)